Lionel Schiepers

Platform architect and DevSecOps engineer



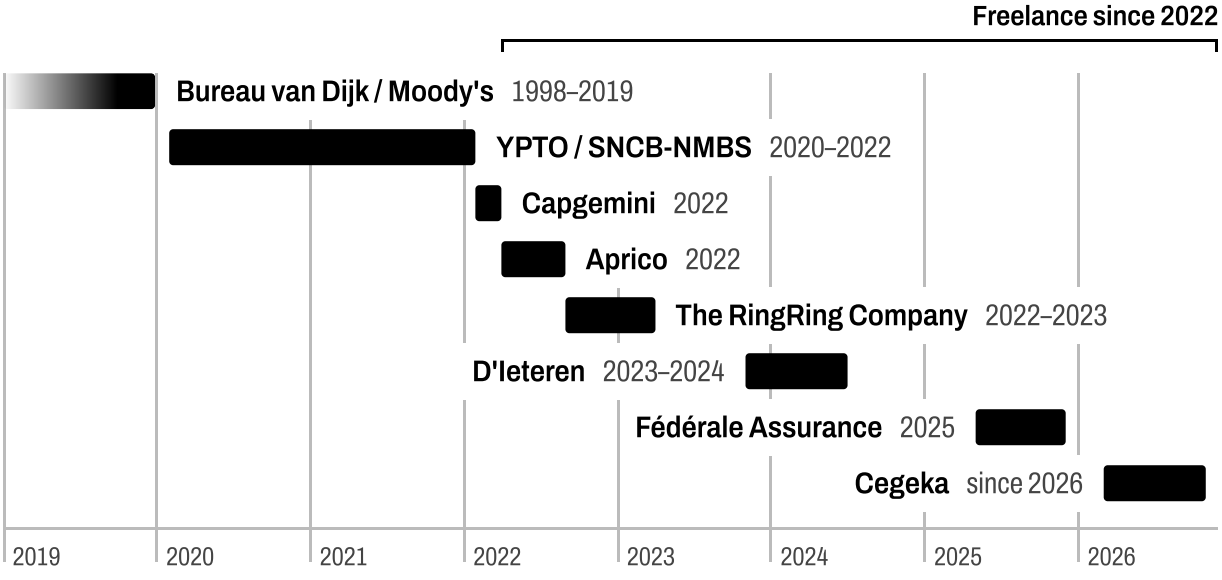
I'm building Cegeka's self-service developer platform, where one click gives a team its GitHub organisation, a secure hub-and-spoke Azure landing zone and delivery pipelines. I work end to end, from infrastructure and automation to security and application code, as I have for financial data, insurance, rail and automotive clients.

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Specialism	Secure Azure landing zones (hub and spoke), cloud-native application design on Azure, internal developer platforms
Works as	Freelance, since 2022
Roles	Platform, cloud or solution architect, lead DevOps engineer
Experience	28 years, since 1998
Based in	Brussels, hybrid or remote across Belgium
Languages	French (native), English (professional)
Core stack	Azure, GitHub Enterprise (EMU, EU data residency), Terraform, .NET, React, Kubernetes



Summary

Platform architect who turns cloud governance into self-service that developers actually enjoy using.

With 28 years of experience, I design scalable, cost-optimized solutions with a strong focus on automation (IaC, CI/CD) and security. Today I build internal developer platforms end to end, from

the Terraform landing zone and the .NET orchestration engine to the React portal teams click on. My expertise spans Azure, GitHub Enterprise, Kubernetes and .NET, and I mentor the teams who use what I build.

Experience

Mar 2026 – present, freelance at Cegeka

Platform Architect

I lead the design and build of Cegeka's self-service internal developer platform. One click in a web portal gives a customer project everything it needs to ship: a GitHub organisation, repositories from templates, an Azure landing zone, pipelines, quality gates and team access.

Impact	Project setup becomes a single click, with the same governance, security baseline and audit trail
Scale	17 orchestrations, 44 activities and 3 codebases (backend, portal, infrastructure), built and led by me
Stack	.NET 10, Azure Durable Functions, React 19, TypeScript, Terraform, GitHub Enterprise, Azure Container Apps, Microsoft Entra ID

- I built the orchestration engine in .NET 10 on Azure Durable Functions and the Durable Task Scheduler, as a modular monolith with domain-driven design (MediatR, EF Core), retries, live progress and about 200 automated tests.
- I built the self-service portal in React 19 and TypeScript, with Entra ID sign-in, a typed client generated from OpenAPI, pre-flight checks and live tracking of long-running operations.
- I automate GitHub Enterprise Cloud: organisations, repositories from templates, environments, private VNet-injected runners and passwordless deployments through OpenID Connect federated identity.
- I provision secure-by-default Azure landing zones with Terraform: hub-and-spoke networking, Application Gateway with WAF, private endpoints, Key Vault, Container Apps, and diagnostics in Log Analytics.
- I onboard every project into SonarQube Cloud, Microsoft Entra ID team groups and Jira automatically, with email notifications and a full audit trail of who changed what.
- I designed the platform on zero-trust principles: private endpoints, with public network access off or limited to the corporate VPN; managed identities between services and OpenID Connect for deployments instead of passwords; Entra ID role-based access for every user and service; and TLS from the gateway to every backend, with certificate validation. Container images are signed and scanned (cosign, Trivy), Microsoft Defender for Cloud is enabled in Terraform, with its recommendations fixed in code rather than by hand to keep the secure score high, and the platform passed an OWASP ASVS Level 2 self-assessment.

May 2025 – Nov 2025, freelance at Fédérale Assurance

Integration Architect & DevOps Engineer

- I modernised more than ten BizTalk orchestrations into secure .NET 10 services (Minimal API, OpenAPI, OAuth 2.0, Key Vault, Application Insights), covered by xUnit unit and integration tests.
- I exposed legacy systems through Azure API Management, deployed with Bicep, as a service catalogue and a security layer for systems without native authentication.
- I migrated more than 50 classic Azure DevOps build pipelines to YAML on a shared framework, cutting maintenance effort.
- I coached developers on modern Azure practice: Container Apps and Durable Functions, managed identity and RBAC instead of passwords, Key Vault, structured logging, and proactive monitoring with OpenTelemetry.
- I challenged solution designs to lower running costs and raise security, and unblocked issues that spanned infrastructure, network, security and development.
- I maintained the on-premises Azure DevOps Server platform.

Nov 2023 – Jun 2024, freelance at D'Ieteren

Azure Architect & DevOps Engineer

- I owned the Azure DevOps CI/CD platform and migrated every pipeline from classic to YAML.
- I led .NET development for the data platform team: microservices in .NET 6 and 8, Azure Durable Functions and SQL Server.
- I delivered containerised GraphQL APIs, including integrating Data API Builder with the in-house authorization provider.
- I upgraded the existing stack, from .NET Core 3.1 to .NET 8, and Durable Functions from in-process to the isolated worker.
- I monitored application health and reviewed designs for security (OAuth, firewalls), performance (HTTP compression, over-fetching, SQL schema) and cost.

Sep 2022 – Mar 2023, freelance at The RingRing Company

Lead DevOps Engineer

- I ran the YAML CI/CD pipelines and the Kubernetes deployments with Octopus Deploy.
- I deployed an on-premises Kubernetes monitoring stack with Prometheus and Grafana.
- I owned code quality with SonarQube.
- I helped developers troubleshoot production incidents and turned the findings into improvements, with an eye on cost and the learning curve.

Apr 2022 – Aug 2022, freelance at Aprico

Solution Architect & Team Lead

- I led a team of developers in Tunisia, as tech lead and Scrum master, building a web and mobile application on Azure.
- I set the .NET 6 architecture: microservices, domain-driven design, event-driven design and CQRS, with unit tests.

- I ran the Azure DevOps environment: CI/CD, Terraform deployments, release management and the Git branching strategy.
- I maintained the network architecture: Application Gateway, load balancing, health probes and firewall.

Feb 2022 – Apr 2022, Capgemini

Senior Consultant

- I designed and deployed a hub-and-spoke network on Azure to host a low-code platform, with segregated production and non-production environments.
- I earned the AZ-204 certification (Developing Solutions for Microsoft Azure).

Feb 2020 – Feb 2022, YPTO / SNCB-NMBS

Technical Architect

- I was application owner of the Jenkins and Azure DevOps CI/CD platforms.
- I led a team of five developers building a React Native mobile app on .NET Core microservices.
- I designed Azure architectures for microservice projects, and OpenAPI and GraphQL APIs.
- I owned code quality, using SonarQube and unit tests.

Jul 1998 – Dec 2019, Bureau van Dijk / Moody's Analytics

Team Lead and Tech Lead

2017 I led a development team, reporting directly to the CTO, and handled planning and career development.

2017 I built a highly available NoSQL cluster storing more than 100 million patent documents.

2016 I set up a cloud infrastructure in China: firewall, load balancer, health monitoring, SQL databases and web servers.

2009 I created a standalone web server, based on Cassini, that shipped web applications on Blu-ray discs to run offline.

2007 I built a distributed application for encoding merger and acquisition data, used in Brussels, Manchester and Singapore and synchronised with SQL merge replication.

2005 I built a distributed monitoring system for web applications, servers and routers that acted on failed nodes and reported to managers and QA.

2000 I built a continuous integration system that automated source branching and setup deployment.

Technologies

Cloud & platform

Azure, Azure Durable Functions, Azure Container Apps, Azure API Management, Kubernetes

Development

.NET / C#, React, TypeScript, APIs (REST, OpenAPI, GraphQL), SQL Server, PowerShell / Bash

Delivery & infrastructure as code

Security & quality

GitHub Enterprise & Actions, Azure DevOps, Terraform, Bicep, Docker

Microsoft Entra ID / OAuth 2.0, Image signing and scanning (cosign, Trivy), SonarQube, OpenTelemetry

Open source

Project owner and creator

StockQuotes.MCP

An AI agent (MCP server) that fetches and processes real-time financial data. View StockQuotes.MCP on GitHub

I build and maintain it in my own time, to the same standard as client work:

- TypeScript, with ESLint and SonarQube quality gates.
- Unit tests that guard against regressions, with high code coverage.
- Automated CI/CD with GitHub Actions and Docker images.

Certifications

AZ-204: Developing Solutions for Microsoft Azure (2022)

Education

Bachelor in Computer Science, 1998
HEPL Rennequin Sualem (INPRES)

Languages

French, native proficiency
English, professional working proficiency

Hobbies

Cooking
Running
Recycling and crafts